



hemispherical
iron cap



Corinthian helmet

c.700 BCE

This helmet is made from a single piece of bronze, giving it extra strength. Such helmets were popular in Greece from the 8th to the 6th centuries BCE.

rigid face
mask, riveted
to cap

decorative
roundel

red glass inlay



Ceremonial shield cover

c.350–50 BCE

Made from a bronze sheet, this shield cover displays the repoussé technique of hammering the reverse side to create a raised design on the front.



Silver plaque

c.300–200 BCE

This plaque depicts the figures of the Greek goddess Aphrodite, her son Eros, and a girl attendant, was made by repoussé. Other decorative incisions have been highlighted with gilding.

stamped
design



Lydian coins

c.700 BCE

The earliest coinage was produced in Lydia (now in Turkey). It was made from electrum—a naturally occurring alloy of silver and gold, which was once believed to be a metal in its own right.

neck guard

Anglo-Saxon helmet (reconstruction)

c.620

Found in a ship burial at Sutton Hoo, UK, the original helmet was made of iron and covered with tinned bronze sheets. It was decorated with silver wire and garnets.



leg shaped
as dragon

Bronze figure

c.1000 BCE

This statuette of a Canaanite god was made with a technique called cire-perdue casting, which uses a single-use mold, and plated with silver using a direct application technique.



Bronze Age vessel

c.800 BCE

This animal-shaped ritual vessel, known as yi, was used in Late Western Zhou China for washing hands before making a sacrifice.

turquoise
eye



Copper mask

c.250

Found in the tomb of a nobleman from the Peruvian Moche culture, this mask shows mastery of metal sculpture. Both eyes were originally inset with turquoise.